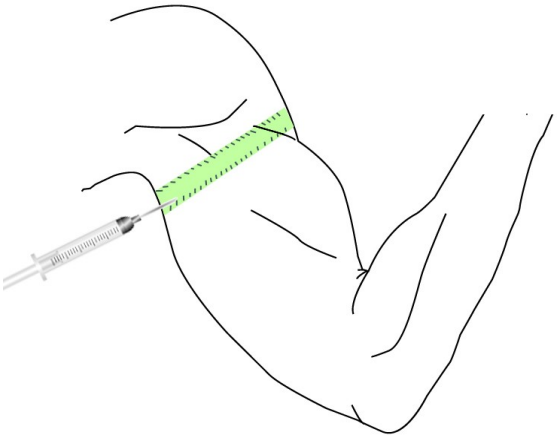
A field block is the injection of a relatively large volume of local anesthetic to anesthetize a region of cutaneous nerves. They are commonly employed by anesthesia providers to supplement patchy areas of peripheral nerve blocks or areas where neuraxial blocks failed to function or have receded.

Other examples of field blocks include: superficial cervical plexus block, intercostobrachial cutaneous, and medial brachial cutaneous. Unlike the median nerve block and ulnar nerve block, the radial nerve is considered a field block because of it's less predictable anatomical location and division into numerous smaller cutaneous branches.



Intercostobrachial and medial brachial cutaneous nerve blocks used to supplement brachial plexus blocks are examples of a field block.

Butterworth JF, Mackey DC, Wasnick JD. Morgan & Mikhail's Clinical Anesthesiology. 5th ed. New York, NY: McGraw-Hill; 2013: 978.

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